ISSUE 31

FALL 2026

HOLLYWOOD INTERNATIONAL FILMMAKER

好莱坞国际电影人

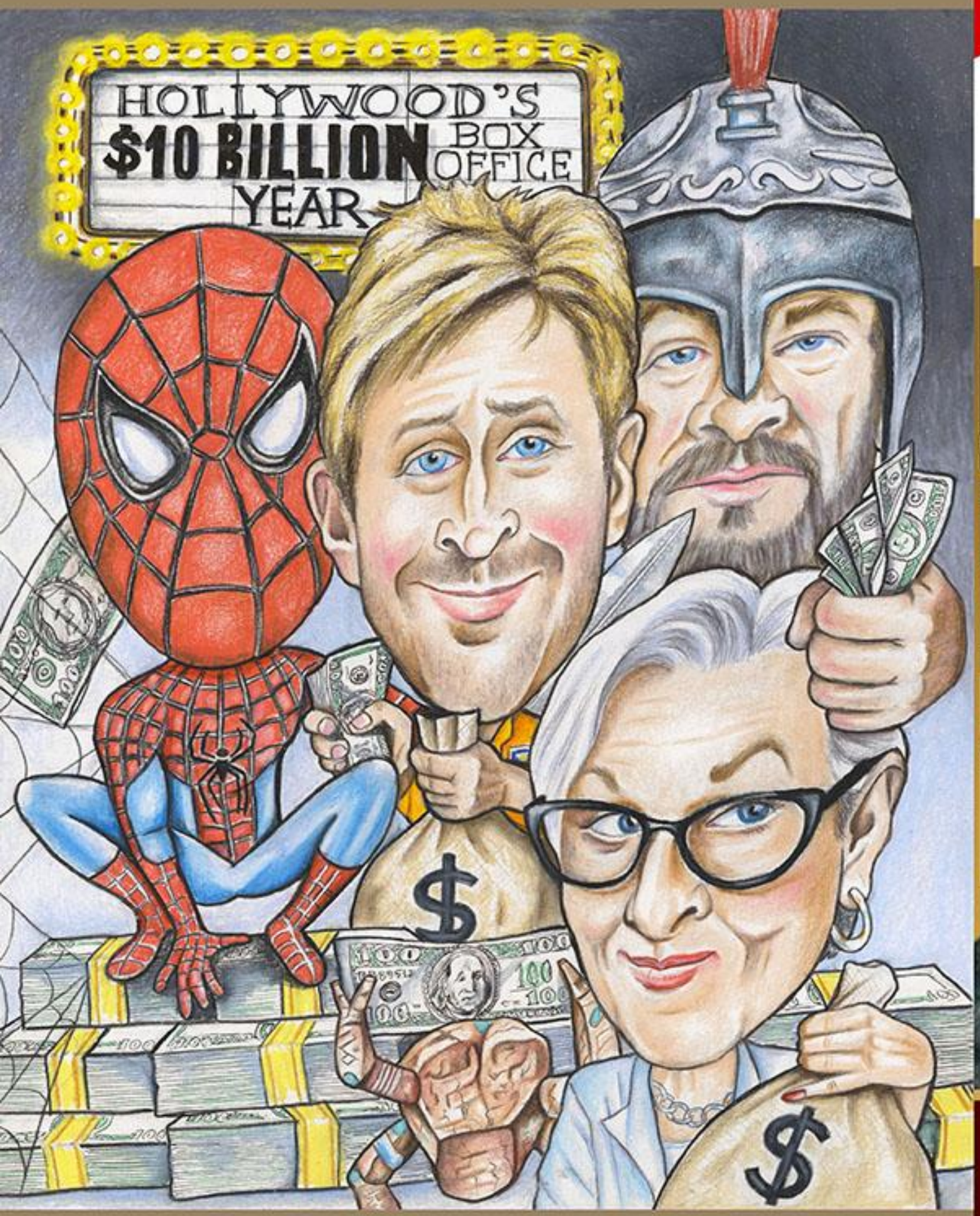
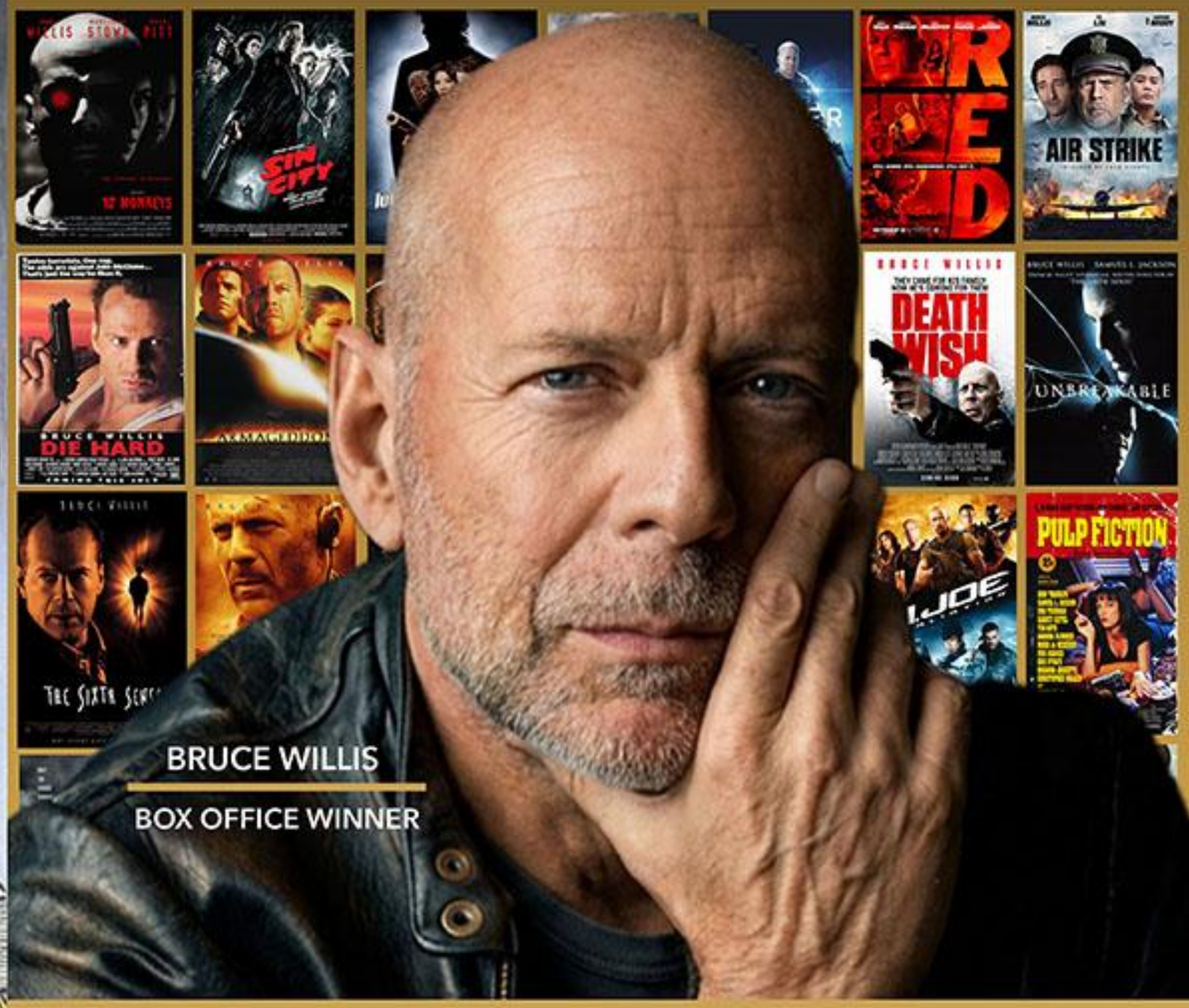


Illustration by Todd Tuttle



- AI FILMS
- COLIN FARRELL
- DREAM OF LOVE
- TAYLOR SWIFT



















QUARTERLY PUBLICATION
Issue 31 | Fall 2026

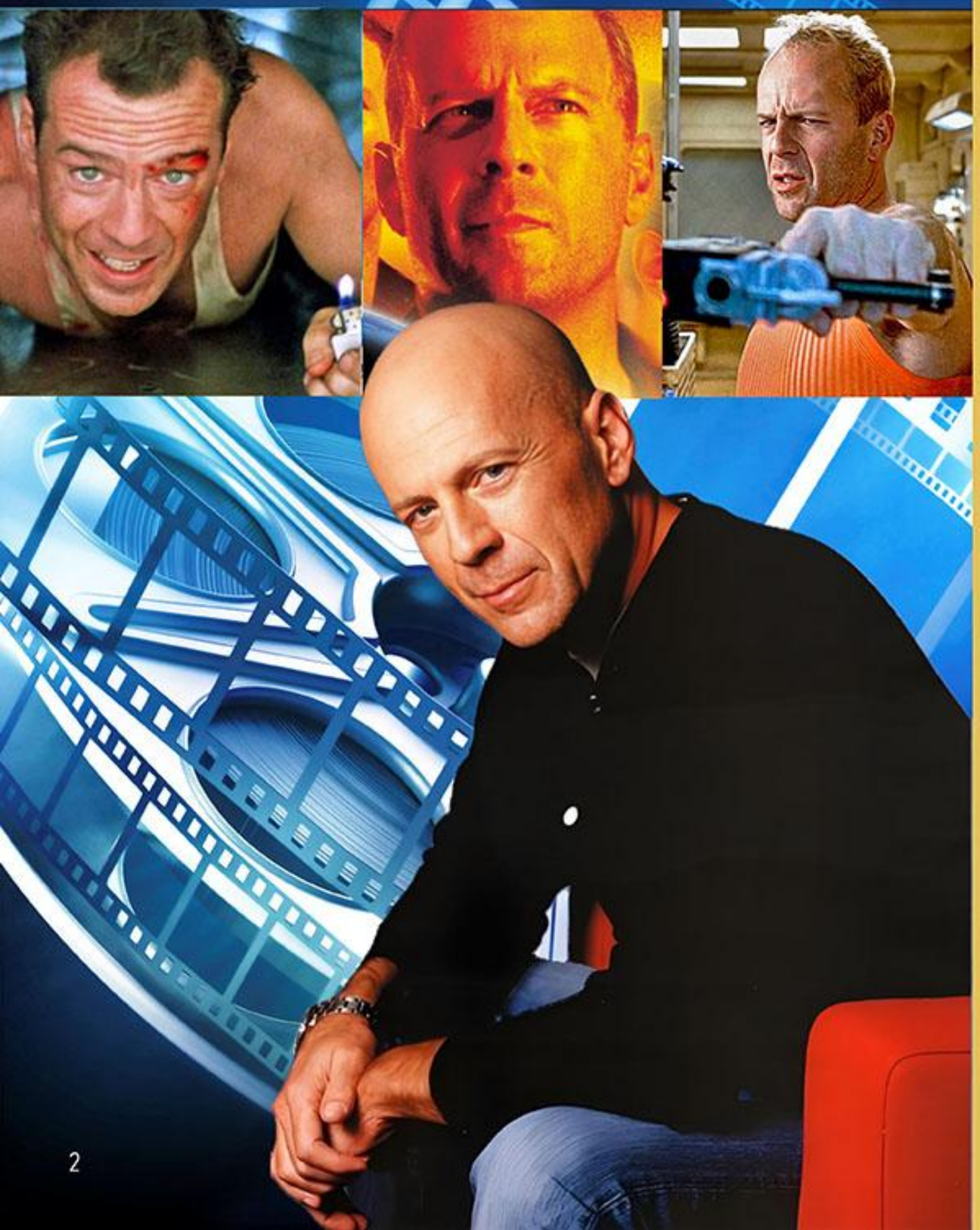
PUBLISHED BY:
Hollywood International Film Exchange
ADDRESS:
6565 East Washington Blvd.,
Los Angeles, CA 90040 USA
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BRUCE WILLIS: HOLLYWOOD HERO

Few stars have ever redefined an entire genre with a single performance, but Bruce Willis did exactly that in 1988 with Die Hard. Before John McClane crashed barefoot through Nakatomi Plaza, action heroes tended to be larger-than-life muscle men. Willis brought something different: vulnerability, wit, frustration and sheer determination. McClane wasn't a superhero. He was a guy having a very bad day. Audiences loved him for it.

The success of Die Hard transformed Willis from television favorite to global movie star and launched one of Hollywood's most successful action franchises. Yet his career was far broader than explosions and one-liners. He delivered memorable performances in Pulp Fiction, 12 Monkeys, Armageddon, The Fifth Element, Unbreakable and The Sixth Sense, along the way becoming one of the world's most bankable stars.

Over four decades, films featuring Willis generated billions of dollars at the global box office, making him one of the most commercially successful actors of his generation. His appeal combined a winning mix of toughness and humor that crossed borders, languages and genres. Whether playing a time-travelling convict, a reluctant hero, a boxer or a ghost-haunted child psychologist, he possessed an unmistakable screen presence.

Even in the later years of his career, Willis remained a familiar face to audiences, appearing in projects such as the vigilante thriller Death Wish and the wartime epic Air Strike. While these films did not match the cultural impact of his greatest hits, they demonstrated his enduring work ethic and commitment to entertaining audiences.

In 2022, Willis retired from acting after being diagnosed with aphasia, a condition affecting communication and language abilities. His family later revealed that his condition had progressed to frontotemporal dementia, a degenerative neurological disease.

For millions of film fans, he remains the gold standard against which every reluctant hero is measured.

Sandro Monetti


40 STORIES OF SHEER ADVENTURE!
High above the city of L.A. a team of terrorists has seized a building, taken hostages, and declared war.
One man has managed to escape... An off-duty cop hiding somewhere inside.
He's alone, tired... and the only chance anyone has got.
BRUCE WILLIS
DIE HARD


BRUCE WILLIS
LIVE FREE OR DIE HARD


FACE YOUR FUTURE.
FIGHT YOUR PAST.
LOOPER
IN CINEMAS SEPTEMBER 28


WILLIS
STOWE
PITT
12 MONKEYS


BRUCE WILLIS
ARMAGEDDON


THE #1 THRILLER OF ALL TIME!
THE SIXTH SENSE


THE Jackal

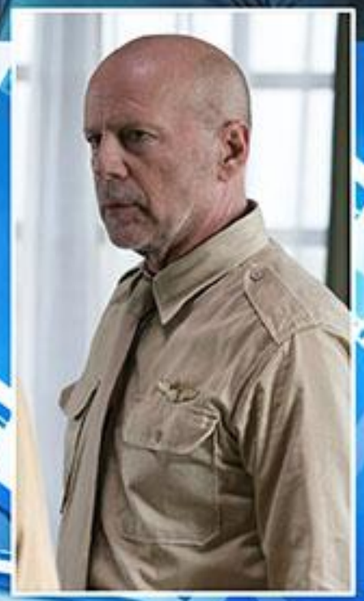

BRUCE WILLIS
THE FIFTH ELEMENT


YIPPEE KI YAY!
Bruce Willis




BRUCE WILLIS
THEY CAME FOR HIS FAMILY
NOW HE'S COMING FOR THEM
DEATH WISH
COMING SOON


UNBREAKABLE SPIRIT






6

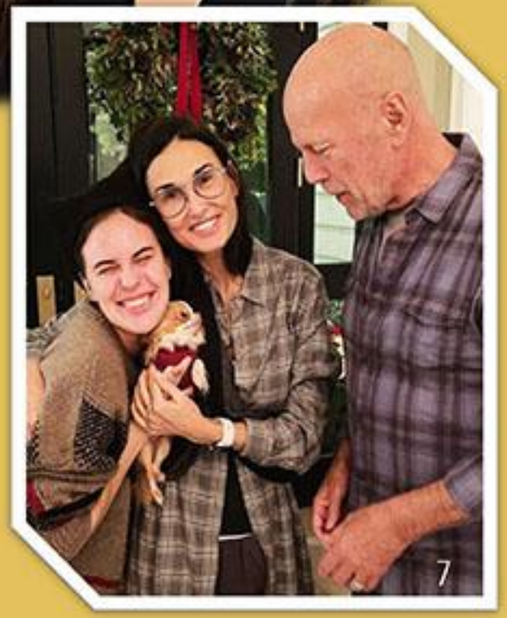











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Godfather 4: The Godmother?

A new Godfather movie could be on the way. Paramount, the studio behind the three previous movies in the Mafia saga, has the film rights to an upcoming book which takes the story in a new direction.

Connie, to be published in 2027 and written by bestselling author Adriana Trigani, tells the Corleone family story from the perspective of Don Corleone's only daughter.

Now the studio must decide whether to move ahead with a female focused continuation of one of the most iconic film franchises ever.

Talia Shire played Connie Corleone in the Godfather trilogy and is the sister of Francis Ford Coppola who directed all three movies. Neither she nor her brother has yet been signed up to the new project.

The Godfather

THE BEST FILM MAGAZINE IN THE WORLD

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Will Smith Launches a Comeback

After largely being out of the spotlight in the four years since slapping Chris Rock at the Oscars, Will Smith is poised for a comeback.

He is set to star as an FBI agent in big budget action thriller Supermax for Amazon MGM. Meanwhile Paramount has signed a first-look deal with the star's entertainment company, Westbrook.

But while Hollywood appears ready to forgive and forget the slap heard around the world, it remains to be seen if audiences are ready to embrace Smith again.



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I Thought We Were Filming a Scene... Until I Realized the Guns Were Real

By Kimberley Kates , CEO, Big Screen

One of the most valuable lessons I've learned as a filmmaker is that sometimes the best stories aren't the ones you write... they're the ones you survive.

That became clear 20 years ago on the first day filming Big Screen's action comedy Forget About It with an all-star cast including Burt Reynolds and Raquel Welch.

After years in front of the camera — playing Princess Elizabeth in Bill & Ted's Excellent Adventure as a teenager, then appearing on Seinfeld, Murder, She Wrote, The Larry Sanders Show, and starring in my own ABC series On Our Own — this was the first movie I was producing as well as acting in and it proved a real baptism by fire.

On arrival at the filming location, ready to play an FBI agent and oversee shooting, I was surprised but excited to see a chase scene already in progress with a man chasing down another man on set, they both had guns drawn and were yelling at each other. It seemed so authentic.

Then it hit me. There were no cameras rolling. No crew. No lights. No sound. This wasn't in the script. This was actually happening — right in front of me — because the money we were supposed to be using to make the movie had disappeared. The man being chased had stolen it and the man racing after him was our film's director!

Real FBI agents eventually sorted out the situation and the bad guy got sent to prison for a string of crimes. And we carried on filming this fun fictional story about stolen money. Welcome to producing, Kimberley!

I went on to co-found and build Big Screen Entertainment Group (OTC: BSEG) into the publicly traded production and distribution powerhouse it is today. We've produced award-winning horror like Babysitter Wanted, big-action titles like Air Strike with Bruce Willis, and launched a streaming channel, Big Stream Entertainment, with over 300 titles.

We're now developing everything the faith-based features like Miracle Ranch, the Avenger Field audio series for Audible, Marilyn Monroe documentaries, and bold expansions into beauty brands.

Twenty years later, I still smile when I think about that crazy first day on Forget About It. Because it didn't break me — it forged me.



"A timeless romance that will break your heart and stay with you forever."

DREAM OF LOVE

Born into one of China's most powerful aristocratic families, the sensitive and rebellious Jia Baoyu has little interest in the wealth and privilege that surround him. Instead, he is drawn to his soulmate, the brilliant but fragile Lin Daiyu, whose intelligence and quiet passion set her apart from everyone else.



As their bond deepens into an unforgettable love, they find themselves trapped by the traditions, expectations and ambitions of a family determined to control their futures.

As fortunes fade and rivalries threaten to tear the household apart, Baoyu is forced towards a marriage arranged for advantage rather than love. Caught between duty and desire, he and Daiyu struggle against forces far greater than themselves, discovering that some destinies cannot be escaped.

Set against the breathtaking beauty of imperial China, *Dream of Love* is an epic tale of romance, heartbreak and sacrifice, where every stolen glance carries the weight of a lifetime and every choice comes at a devastating cost. Rich with lavish spectacle and timeless emotion, this sweeping adaptation of one of the world's greatest literary classics explores the price of following your heart in a world where tradition rules above all else.



AND THE OSCAR GOES TO... TAYLOR SWIFT?

Music icon Taylor Swift has dominated the Grammy Awards in recent years but soon she could win her first Oscar.

That's because the superstar's track from Toy Story 5 – inspired by the cowgirl doll character Jessie – is an early favourite for the next Academy Award for best motion picture song.

Country-pop tune If I Knew It, I Knew You could put the world's most popular entertainer on the Oscars stage, which would surely send ratings through the roof.

But nothing is guaranteed because the Academy's music branch is not always in awe of celebrity or chart hits and no country song has ever won an Oscar.

If there are some Swifties among the voters, however, that could all change and Taylor might achieve yet another career milestone.





Cementing His Legacy



The oldest and most enduring honor in Hollywood is the hand and footprint ceremony at the TCL Chinese Theatre.

It's a tradition which began in 1927 – two years before the first Oscars – when silent film legends Douglas Fairbanks and Mary Pickford were the first stars to make their mark in cement on the cinema forecourt.

The latest was Spanish actor Javier Bardem who said: "It's an honor to be part of this remarkable Hollywood tradition to be included amongst so many extraordinary artists who have left a lasting impact on our cinema."

Bardem's impact has included an Oscar win for No Country for Old Men and a string of memorable performances in films such as Skyfall, Dune, Before Night Falls and recent Apple TV series Cape Fear.

Filmmakers Denis Villeneuve, Michael Mann and Jerry Bruckheimer – all of whom have worked with Bardem – attended the event and congratulated the star.

- Sandro Monetti

5 Questions for Colin Farrell



While promoting the second season of his Apple TV series Sugar, movie star Colin Farrell caught up with our own Sandro Monetti, with whom he co-produced Oscar shortlisted short film Room Taken, and answered these five questions.



Your character in Sugar loves Hollywood movies but what film is your favorite?

I'll go with L.A. Confidential. Love that film. Everything about that is just perfect. Curtis Hanson's directing, every single musical cue, the cinematography, how L.A. looks, how it feels. David Strathairn. All the actors. You know, Spacey, Pearce. Russel Crowe. James Cromwell who was in the first season and features a little bit in the second season of Sugar. It's just a masterclass of filmmaking and performance and mood.

In Sugar, you play an extraterrestrial disguised as human private investigator. Do you think aliens really could be living among us?

So interesting, isn't it? My God, I'd love to know. Maybe when I was a kid I didn't think so. But for as long as I can remember now, I've always thought there's probably, of course, many other worlds, many other civilizations, sentient beings, you know? I would imagine there's a good chance that we've been watched for a long, long time.

What scares you?

I'm so afraid of flying. I've got envy of anyone who is calm about getting on a plane. I just put one foot in front of the other to do it. I just have a very rapid, nervous, anxious response when we hit turbulence, especially if we're over the water. My head is a disaster sometimes, you know. Runs away from me from time to time, and hitting turbulence is one of the cases when it does.



It's more than 20 years since you made the film Alexander, directed by Oliver Stone, what's he like?

I've met a lot of bright people in my time. More bright people than it looked like I was going to meet, because I didn't even finish high school. But I have, through my work as an actor, been fortunate to encounter some really, really brilliant men and women. And I don't know that I've ever met anyone more brilliant than Oliver Stone. Like, truly. He is a voracious reader. A consummate thinker. Particularly in relation to world politics and the global stage. And our responsibility to each other as human beings. He's an extraordinary patriot. I'm not saying everything he's done is right, but I believe the man just cares deeply about human beings. He really does. Oliver is amazing.







Congratulations on recently turning 50. How do you reflect on that landmark birthday?

I did find myself being surprisingly reflective. It caught me, just the number. I just, you know, reflected on my life for a bit. And not much of it was in relation to career. Truly it was more in relation to the obvious things, you know, where I came from, where I am, kind of family and friends, and loss and this and that and the other, you know, that kind of thing. And also, I was thinking of mortality and it's like, whoa. So when the road gets shorter ahead of you than it was behind you, it becomes a very real thing and an intriguing thing, you know, the existence of that one great certainty that we all share. We don't think about it of course when we're young and then it becomes more apparent.

5 Questions for Paul Rudd



From Clueless to latest film Power Ballad, Paul Rudd has been entertaining audiences for 30 years - along the way scoring big hits like Anchorman and Ant-Man. Here he talks about his long time at the top.

POWER BALLAD

How do you reflect on your enduring career and the turning points in it?

Having a long career kind of sneaks up on you, honestly. It's a little bit like doing yard work, you know, or mowing a lawn. You're just kind of focusing on that patch of grass in front of you, and you're just pushing this thing and pushing this thing. And finally, you kind of stop after a while, look back, and realize you've mowed just a giant lawn. So, in looking back on the mowed lawn that is my IMDB page, there are certain things that do stick out as being seminal experiences and ones that I think probably thrust me into a different category. When Anchorman happened, all of a sudden, I was working with Judd Apatow and a lot of the same comedic actors. That was a really amazing time in my life and in my career. Then, certainly, the Marvel stuff. It was the first thing I ever did that kids had seen. So, my life changed drastically. 'Cause I'd be out, and a little kid would go, "How's Iron Man?" That was a new thing. And in other countries, it was so visible.

Has being so visible complicated your life?

Yeah, sure. There are certain things that become more complicated just in life because I've had some success in this career. And while there are so many benefits and things that are nice, there are other things that become a little trickier. I've really noticed the difference since the Marvel stuff, obviously just 'cause of the level of visibility. Certain things become a little tricker to just kind of be in big, large crowds or whatever it is. But I tend not to focus or talk too much about what's difficult about being famous, 'cause it's a ridiculous thing to talk about, and you sound like a real jerk.







How do you pick projects?

It's never really changed. It's would I wanna see it? That's the first thing. Second, is there something about it that really resonates with me, that I'm drawn to? And it's like, oh, I think this would be fun to play. Usually, you can tell when you're reading it, like, you're imagining doing it. You're imagining how you would kind of tackle a role. Like, I think about that. How they turn out is a completely different thing. I go into just about every single thing I've ever done, and I've gone in with, "Like, this could be great." Like, I really have an optimistic point of view about it. And they don't always turn out, and that can be a little demoralizing or a lot demoralizing. But I don't think of the success really in box office. I think of it in terms of what I gained from it personally. Experiences themselves, they do count for a lot. I've had some really, really great experiences working on things. But the thing that really is the North Star for me is, would I wanna see it? And is there something within me that is drawing me to trying to tackle the role?

You've described your latest role, as a musician in Power Ballad, as your dream part. Why?

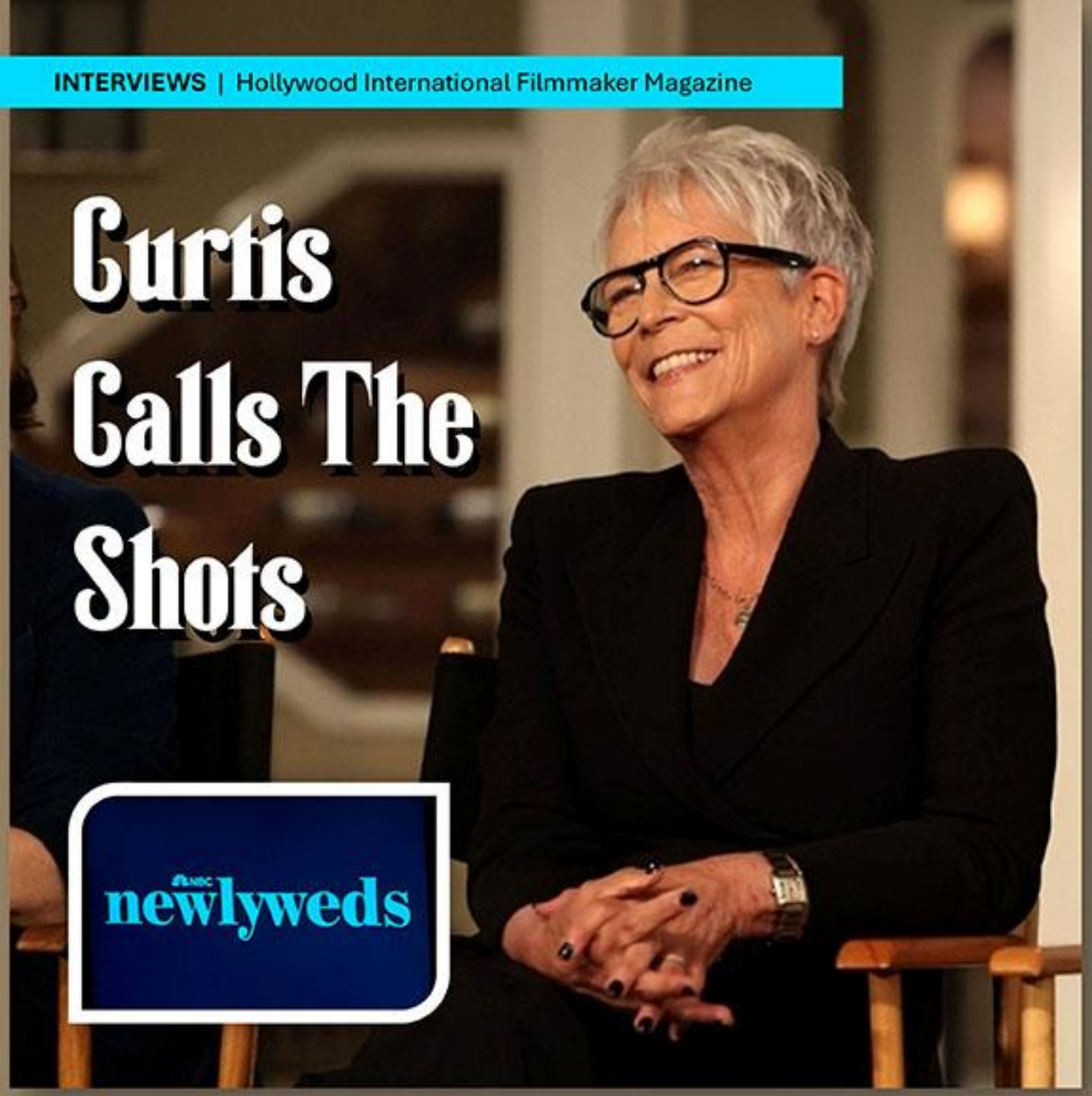
I did find myself being surprisingly reflective. It caught I like to play music. I like to sing in the way that everyone kinda does and I've played guitar for many years, but I tend to play on my own. Here I was around real musicians and I would like to think that just being around that ups your game. This is not my lane, really, but they were certainly nice and welcoming and made me feel as if I, you know, could hang in the room. It was also a dream role because it was set in Ireland and I'm such a fan of Irish music, Guiness, pubs and the literature that comes out of Ireland. I love it all.

You're from New Jersey so where does your love of Ireland come from?

I know Ireland pretty well. I've been there many times. It's one of my favorite places. My dad was a Titanic historian and spent a lot of time in Ireland. That was how he made his living, actually. He used to take lots of people through Ireland, and in particular, Cobh which was the last port of call for Titanic before she sailed to New York on the fateful voyage. So, I'd spent a lot of time there with my dad. I feel very comfortable and at home in Ireland and that's due in large part because a lot of Irish people make you feel that way. So, it was great to film there. A dream role.

- Sandro Monetti

Curtis Calls The Shots



Movie icon Jamie Lee Curtis has had a glittering career in films but is now finding her greatest happiness being in charge of a new TV sitcom.

After starring in hits like True Lies, Trading Places, Halloween, A Fish Called Wanda and Everything Everywhere All at Once, she's currently executive producing and appearing in NBC comedy series Newlyweds, which the actress co-created.

"It's my favorite job, I love the whole part of it, every aspect of it, the dance with the cameras, the idea that you actually get to rehearse something and work it and learn a joke and play it," she said.







"I'm 68 years old, and every single year, all I've ever said to my agents is 'I want to do a sitcom, all I want to do is a sitcom.' I just never got to do it, and so I just decided to basically kind of create my own job."

Newlyweds is a later-in-life love story and Jamie Lee loves her recurring guest star role as the sharp-tongued ex-wife of a buttoned-up college professor but also adores getting to call the shots on set as executive producer.

"I've wanted to be a boss my whole life. I like to refer to myself as the HBIC, head bitch in charge," she laughed.

While streaming dominates the television landscape, Jamie Lee is thrilled to be making a sitcom for network television.

"It's must-see free TV," she added. "You have to remember, a lot of people don't have any money anymore, people are really struggling, and cable and all of the things you have to spend money on. This is network television, and I actually think this whole nostalgia of what sitcoms bring you into your house, things do come around.

"I just think people want to have a good time in the comfort of their own home, and they want to turn on a network show and have laughs and have feelings. That's what sitcoms do, and that's why we love them."

AI FILMS GO LEGIT



The first AI film ever to premiere at a major film festival as part of the official line up is live-action drama Dreams of Violets.



Showcased in New York at the prestigious Tribeca festival in June 2026, the full-length AI-generated film used no actors, sets or cameras.

"The Tribeca Festival has long championed artists who push the boundaries of storytelling and explore new creative frontiers," said Tribeca co-founder Jane Rosenthal when announcing the selection.

Made for just $2,000, the history making movie is about a massacre of Iranian civilians by Iranian regime forces.

The film's director Ash Koosha left Iran in 2009 and is now based in London where he runs Fountain O, a film production company specializing in the kind of AI tools which were used for video generation and editing of Dreams of Violets.

The Plot Twist Nobody Saw Coming: Why A24 Just Said Yes to Google DeepMind

For years, Hollywood has treated artificial intelligence like the monster lurking in the shadows.

Writers and actors went on strike partly over fears that AI could erode creative jobs, while filmmakers warned that machines should never replace human imagination. So when indie powerhouse A24 accepted a reported $75 million investment from Google DeepMind to develop AI tools together, the industry did a genuine double take.

The fiercely independent studio behind *Everything Everywhere All at Once*, Marty Supreme and *Moonlight* has become the industry's gold standard for bold, filmmaker-driven cinema, earning a reputation for backing original voices rather than franchise sequels or superhero spectacles.

But this partnership appears to be aiming at something different and unexpected.

Rather than building software to churn out entire films, Google DeepMind and A24 say they want to develop AI tools that support filmmakers behind the scenes.

Early ideas reportedly include smarter storyboarding, production planning and other creative workflows that could save time without taking decisions away from directors, writers or cinematographers.

For Google DeepMind, the attraction is obvious. If you're building creative AI, who better to work with than one of the world's most respected film studios?

Independent filmmaking has become dramatically more expensive and financially uncertain. A24 appears to believe that if AI is coming anyway, filmmakers should help shape it before someone else does.

By joining forces, perhaps these companies are making a bet that the future of filmmaking won't be written by engineers alone. Instead, it will be co-written by the storytellers who understand that technology is only ever as powerful as the human imagination behind it.

- **Sandro Monetti**





ART NOT ALGORITHMS, WHY GUILLERMO DEL TORO SAID NO TO AI

When Guillermo del Toro appeared at San Diego Comic-Con to unveil the 20th anniversary restoration of Pan's Labyrinth, he wasn't simply announcing a new release. He was making a passionate defense of the people behind filmmaking. Standing before a packed audience, the Oscar-winning director made one thing unmistakably clear: "Absolutely no goddamn AI." The line drew loud applause, but Del Toro was quick to explain that his objection wasn't to technology itself. Rather, he was arguing that technology should help artists—not replace their judgment.

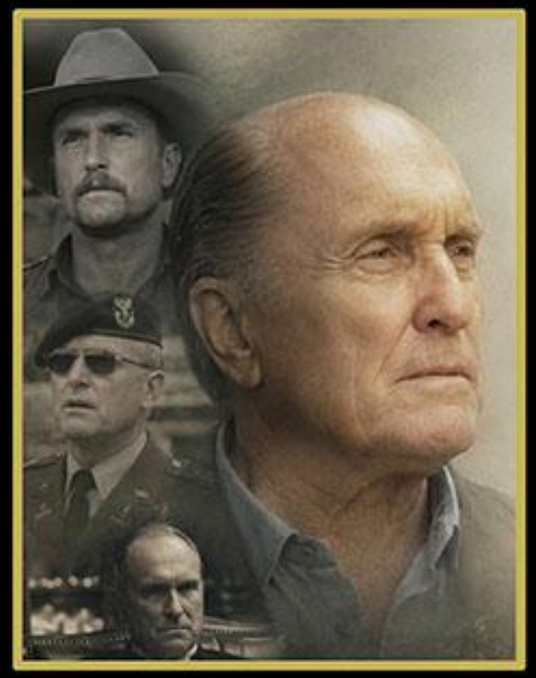
The new edition of Pan's Labyrinth has been painstakingly restored in 4K with HDR and a hand-crafted 3D conversion. Instead of letting artificial intelligence analyze the original images and automatically create depth, around 1,000 artists worked shot by shot, deciding how every scene should look in three dimensions.

Del Toro admitted this approach took longer and cost considerably more, but he believed those creative decisions belonged to people. As he put it, "I chose good" over doing it quickly, adding simply, "A human made a decision of depth." That distinction lies at the heart of his argument. Del Toro wasn't claiming that AI is inherently bad. He was saying there is a profound difference between using technology as a tool and allowing it to replace human creativity. A restoration is filled with artistic choices—how much film grain to preserve, how colors should be balanced, how sharp an image should appear, or how much depth a 3D scene should have. Those are matters of taste, experience and emotion. Del Toro believes they should remain in human hands.

His deepest concern, however, was for the future of the craft. "What we're protecting is the beauty and the redeeming power of art," he told the Comic-Con audience. "We are protecting a lineage of art." He warned that if artists no longer learn these painstaking skills because software does the work instead, "you're cutting the rest of the history of that medium away."

Visually stunning fantasy film Pan's Labyrinth, which won three Oscars, argues that humanity is defined by the choices we make, even when the easier path lies before us. By refusing to let AI make artistic decisions during the restoration, Del Toro believes he is preserving not just a beloved classic, but the human creativity that made it possible in the first place.

- Sandro Monetti



Robert Duvall

(1931–2026)

Robert Duvall never chased stardom. Instead, he pursued something far more enduring: authenticity.

Across more than six decades, he became one of the greatest screen actors of his generation, creating characters so truthful that audiences rarely saw "Robert Duvall" at all. They saw Tom Hagen's quiet loyalty in The Godfather, the unforgettable swagger of Lieutenant Colonel Kilgore in Apocalypse Now, and the wounded soul of Mac Sledge in Tender Mercies, his Academy Award winning role. Every performance carried the same hallmark—absolute honesty.

Duvall possessed a rare confidence that allowed him to underplay rather than overstate. A glance, a smile or a measured silence could reveal more than pages of dialogue. That gift earned him the admiration of generations of actors, and critics, who regarded him as the consummate professional.

I told him as much when starting my interview with him for The Judge, a role for which Duvall would earn his seventh Oscar nomination. Hearing my English accent and sizing me up as I spoke, he asked: "Do you like Michael Owen?"

That one took me by surprise. Could he mean Michael Owen, the former England soccer player? "Yes," I replied. "Great footballer." Duvall was thrilled: "The best of all time in my opinion. Never mind Messi, Maradona or Pele, Michael Owen beats them all in my book."

The great actor went on to explain that since making a soccer movie called A Shot at Glory he had become a huge fan of the sport and it was now his second biggest passion after, of all things, Argentinian tango dancing, which he delighted in for its grace, discipline and emotional intensity.

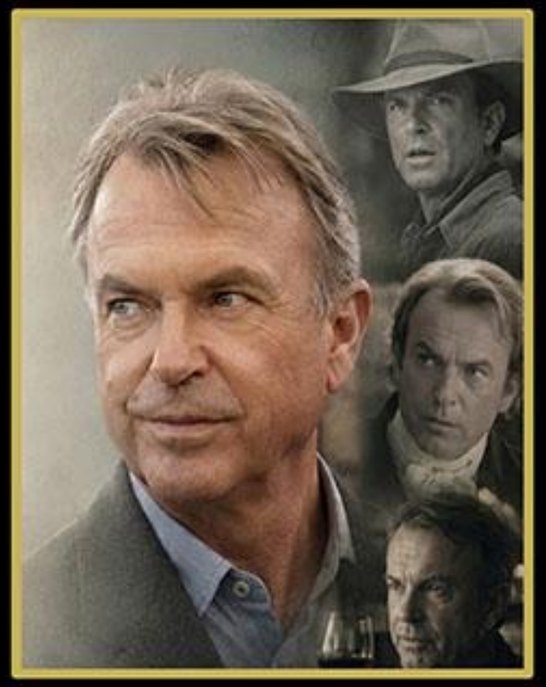
Away from Hollywood, Duvall clearly followed passions that reflected his curiosity about life beyond the camera.

Robert Duvall leaves behind a body of work that represents the very best of cinema. The life he lived beyond the screen reminds us that greatness is measured not only by talent, but by curiosity, generosity and a lifelong commitment to doing the things one truly loves.

- Sandro Monetti

Sam Neill

(1947–2026)



There was something instantly reassuring about Sam Neill. Whether confronting dinosaurs, navigating period drama or exploring the darkest corners of psychological horror, he carried himself with warmth, intelligence and effortless charm.

He was one of those rare actors who could anchor the biggest Hollywood blockbuster while remaining equally compelling in intimate independent films.

To millions he will forever be Dr. Alan Grant, the reluctant hero of Jurassic Park, bringing wonder, wit and humanity to one of cinema's greatest adventures.

Yet that iconic role was only one chapter in a remarkable career that embraced Dead Calm, The Hunt for Red October, The Piano, Event Horizon, The Dish, Peaky Blinders and countless other memorable performances.

Neill's gift as an actor was his quiet authenticity. He never overwhelmed a scene, yet somehow always became its emotional center. Whether playing heroes, rogues or ordinary men, he brought intelligence, kindness and a gentle twinkle that audiences instinctively trusted.

Away from film, Neill created a life every bit as rich as the characters he portrayed. At his beloved Two Paddocks winery in New Zealand, he became a passionate winemaker, finding as much satisfaction among the vines as he did on a film set. Meanwhile his farm became almost as famous as his movies, populated by an assortment of animals that he mischievously named after fellow stars. There was a cow called Helena Bonham Carter, a rooster called Michael Fassbender, and perhaps most famously, a chicken named Meryl Streep. When a ferret sadly killed the pet hen, Neill's wonderfully understated announcement; "Meryl Streep was killed by a ferret. I found her in a pile of feathers" became an instant favorite among his followers, perfectly capturing the dry humor that made him such a delightful companion beyond the screen.

Those glimpses into his everyday life revealed a man who found joy in simple pleasures and never took either himself or his celebrity too seriously.

Sam Neill leaves behind a remarkable body of work, but perhaps an even greater legacy as one of the genuine gentlemen of world cinema.

- Sandro Monetti


Christian Mercuri


Curry Baker



BOX OFFICE OBSESSION

The staggering box office success of horror film Obsession – shot for $750,000 and making $333 million at the global box office – has seen some really big winners.

Not least Capstone Pictures who fully financed the film, then sold it to Focus Features for $15 million after a great response at the Toronto Film Festival and banked a further $50 million from the box office profits as the supernatural film became the biggest Focus hit ever. Capstone – led by producer Christian Mercuri – believed in the vision of the film's 26-year-old writer-director Curry Baker before anyone else and Baker is also a big beneficiary of the success.

He has already signed to write and direct an A24 reboot of horror classic The Texas Chainsaw Massacre and received offers up to $10 million for whatever he wants to make after that.

Meanwhile the previously unheralded cast – including Inde Navarrette – are fielding offers for major film and TV roles.

Obsession, which was shot in just 20 days, is about a hopeless romantic who wishes for a co-worker to fall desperately in love with him only for the romantic fantasy to turn into a nightmare.

Sandro Monetti

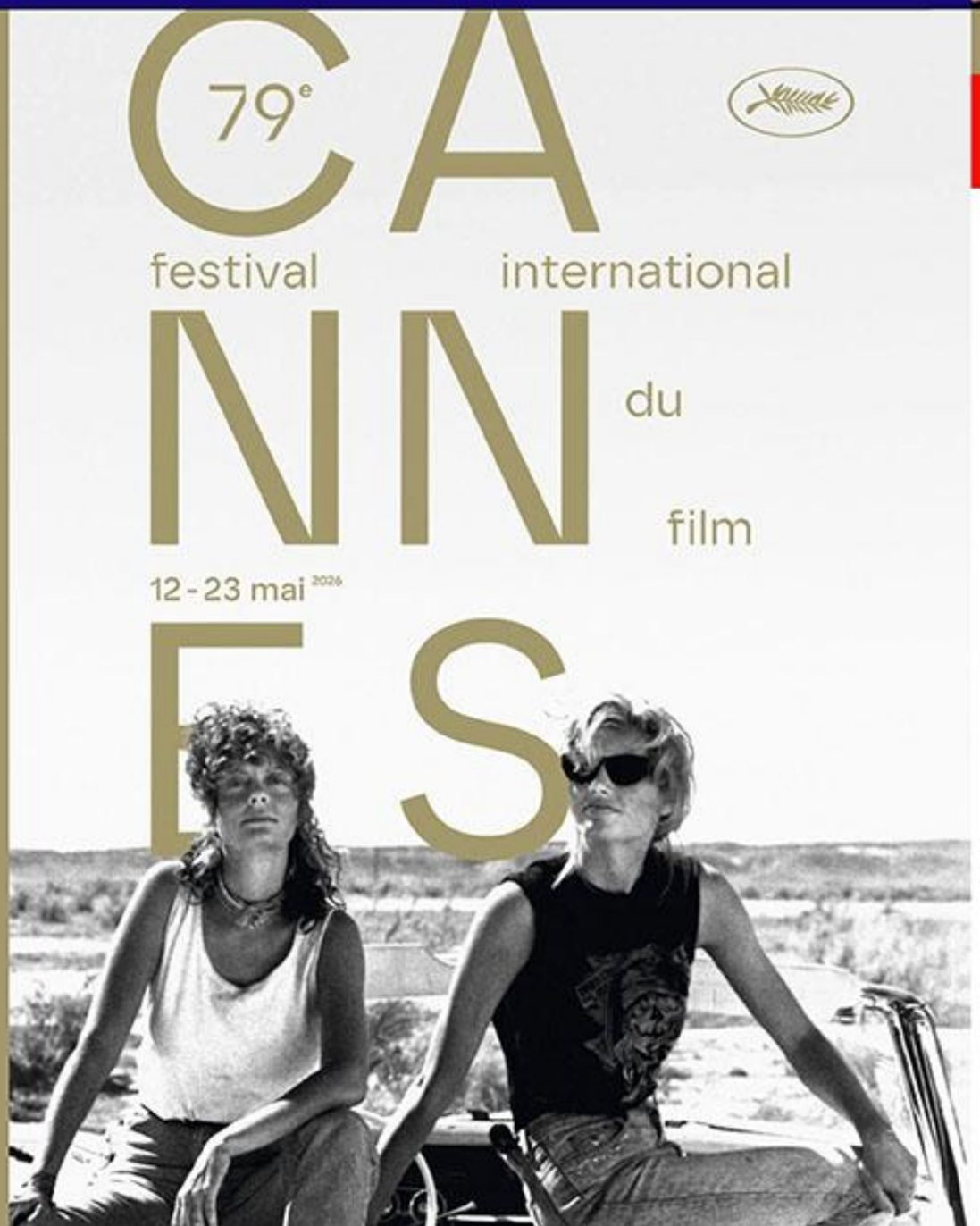












The **Can't** *Film Festival*

This year's Cannes Film Festival had no Hollywood studio movies making the glamorous event far more muted than usual.

Industry instability, cost-cutting and even fear of rough early reviews from notoriously harsh French film critics were all cited as reasons for the Tinseltown skipping the Croisette.

Studios preferred to hold their major titles for later in the year and that also led to fewer stars on the red carpet.

But with no Hollywood blockbuster premieres, Cannes 2026 put an even bigger focus on international and independent films.

That was also reflected in the festival's top awards and multilingual drama Fjord – about a Romanian and Norwegian couple navigating a clash of cultures - won the top prize, the Palme d'Or.











THE RETURN OF RICK MORANIS

Rick Moranis has emerged from retirement to star in the sequel to one of his most enduringly popular films.

The Honey I Shrunk the Kids and Ghostbusters star stepped away from movies but is back next year in a new Spaceballs film.

Forty years after the original Star Wars parody was released, he returns to the role of villain Dark Helmet in Spaceballs: The New One.

Following the death of his wife, Moranis dedicated himself to being a full time single father to their two children and this will be his first movie appearance in three decades.

He had been in talks for years about a follow up with Spaceballs creator and co-star Mel Brooks – who also returns in the new movie – and finally the right circumstances came together
Rock said: "People stop me in the street all the time to ask 'When are you guys going to finally make a sequel to that thing?'

"It just felt like this was the right time. I said yes and it is the best decision I ever made."

That was proven this summer when the beloved actor received a standing ovation at Comic-Con when appearing to announce his return to the role.



GOALS, CAMERA, ACTION! THE BEST SOCCER FILMS

If the World Cup made you a fan of soccer then there are many great films about the sport which will only intensify your passion. Here are seven of the very best. - **Sandro Monetti**

THE DAMNED UNITED

Michael Sheen gives a career best performance as controversial and outspoken manager Brian Clough in this drama about his disastrous 44-day spell in charge of English team Leeds United.

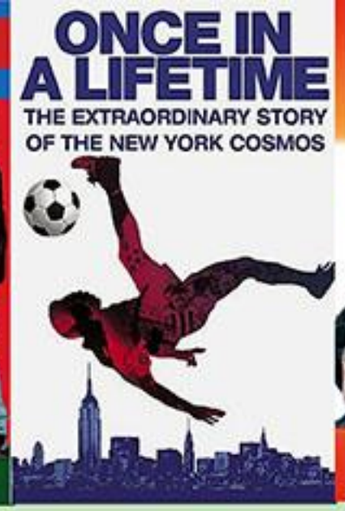
VICTORY

In World War II, Allied Prisoners of War in a Nazi camp play an exhibition match against a German team and see it as an opportunity to make a daring escape. Sylvester Stallone plays the goalkeeper.











BEND IT LIKE BECKHAM

Charming comedy about an 18-year-old girl forbidden by her traditional family from playing soccer who secretly joins a local women's team and opens up new horizons.

FEVER PITCH

Romantic comedy starring Colin Firth as an obsessed fan of Arsenal FC who falls in love with a work colleague who has no interest whatsoever in the sport.

ONCE IN A LIFETIME

Stylish documentary about how Brazilian soccer superstar Pele signed for New York Cosmos in the 1970s and briefly made America fall in love with the sport.

MIKE BASSETT ENGLAND MANAGER

Hilarious comedy in which England appoint an inept manager to run the national team after nobody else wants the job. Things start out badly but he gets a shot of redemption in the World Cup.

GOAL!

A Mexican immigrant living in Los Angeles dreams of being a professional soccer player. He is talented scouted by an English team and moves to the UK to try and prove himself in the big time.



While Star Trek is celebrating its 60th anniversary this year, the space saga is also facing an uncertain future with no new movie or TV series currently in production. Among parts of the fan community, there is growing concern that the franchise's long-standing commitment to diversity and representation could come under pressure following Paramount's change in ownership, particularly in a political climate where some critics have dismissed those values as 'woke.' Paramount's new leadership, however, has not indicated that it intends to change the franchise's core ethos. Several Trek actors have expressed confidence that the brand can live long and prosper for another 60 years and beyond by retaining those founding values.



Among them is Robert Picardo who played the Doctor in both Star Trek: Voyager and the recently cancelled Starfleet Academy.

He said: "Star Trek's core value is diversity and inclusion and although presently that is out of fashion with current politics, Star Trek has survived 60 years. Current politics will not survive 60 years from now, so I believe that Star Trek's values will outlive present weather conditions in our culture."

Dominic Keating, who played Malcolm Reed in Star Trek Enterprise, added: "The fact that the last show has been untimely taken off the air is a little disconcerting. It's a shame it was too woke for some but what is Star Trek if not about representation?
"It will be interesting to see where this franchise could go next. I can't tell you what the next chapter will be but there will be another chapter. I think this is a forever thing as the love is there, the support is there."

Producer Rod Roddenberry, the son of Trek creator Gene Roddenberry who helps steward his father's legacy, stated that Star Trek's greatest message is its optimistic vision of humanity and its continuing commitment to openness, curiosity and "infinite diversity in infinite combinations."

The true mission of Star Trek, he suggested, was to depict "a united humanity exploring the stars," a vision that continues to resonate with audiences in shows like the currently airing Strange New Worlds.

- Words by Sandro Monetti & Photos by Todd Williamson

MOVIE MASTERPIECES TURNING FIFTY

1976



Some of the most iconic movies of all time are celebrating their 50th anniversary this year.

The films listed on these pages came from a period which produced conditions conducive to boundary pushing storytelling.

In 1976 as America celebrated its bicentennial, the nation was full of institutional distrust following Watergate and the Vietnam War and this disillusionment fed into the films being made.

It was also an auteur driven era where directors were given more creative control than ever before and that enabled them to explore anti-heroes, unhappy endings, urban realism and political paranoia.













Here are ten of the best from that golden year of filmmaking genius.

ROCKY

TAXI DRIVER

THE OMEN

"ALL THE PRESIDENT'S MEN"

NETWORK

marathon man

LOGAN'S RUN

"CARRIE"

A STAR IS BORN

THE BAD NEWS Bears







LOSING CHRISTOPHER NOLAN WAS A DISASTER FOR WARNER BROS



Hollywood studios spend billions acquiring famous brands. Warner Bros. already had one of the most valuable brands in modern cinema—and then let it walk out of the door.

That brand wasn't Batman or Superman. It was Christopher Nolan. Over the course of twenty years, Warner Bros. and Nolan built one of the most successful partnerships in film history. Together they delivered *The Dark Knight* trilogy, *Inception*, *Interstellar*, *Dunkirk* and more. Audiences learned that a film bearing the words *"A Film by Christopher Nolan"* promised ambition, spectacle and an experience worth leaving the sofa for. In an age dominated by franchises, Nolan himself had become the franchise.

Then came the pandemic. Faced with empty cinemas, WarnerMedia announced that its entire 2021 slate, including Nolan's latest film *Tenet*, would debut simultaneously on HBO Max and in theatres. The decision may have made short-term commercial sense, but it infuriated filmmakers who believed they had been sidelined. Nolan, one of cinema's fiercest champions of the theatrical experience, publicly condemned the move as a "bait and switch" and criticized the lack of consultation. It proved to be the breaking point in a partnership that had lasted two decades.

Universal Pictures recognized what Warner Bros. appeared to overlook: Christopher Nolan wasn't simply another director for hire. He was a filmmaker whose name alone could sell tickets worldwide. The studio offered him the exclusive theatrical release, creative freedom and confidence he wanted, securing *Oppenheimer* and, later, *The Odyssey*.

The irony could hardly be greater. Warner Bros. invested twenty years building Christopher Nolan into one of the few directors whose name alone attracts audiences. Then it watched a rival studio collect the rewards, as *Oppenheimer* became a global box-office sensation and the Academy Award winner for Best Picture. It's a double success which Nolan looks odds on to repeat with The Odyssey.

Studios can always buy another comic-book license or reboot another franchise. Finding another Christopher Nolan—and keeping him—is considerably harder.

- **Sandro Monetti**

Sandro at the Cinema

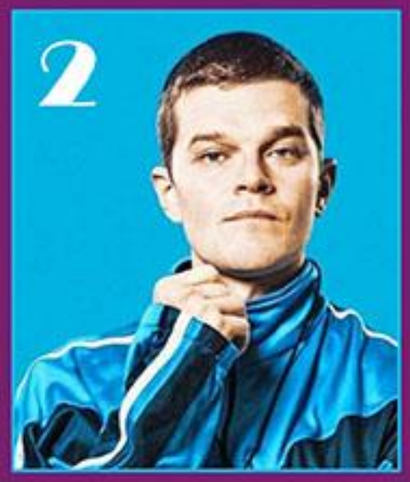


Films released later in the year traditionally dominate the awards races, but our critic Sandro Monetti urges voters not to forget his favorite four films released in the first half of 2026, all of which he argues deserve nominations.



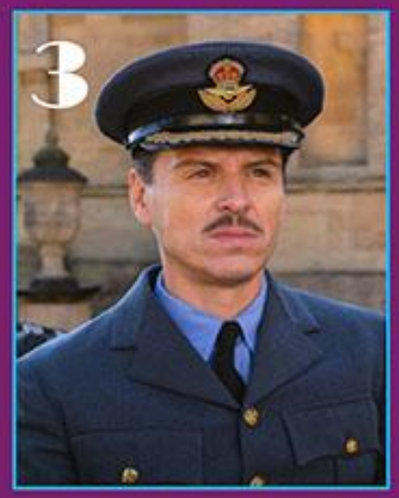
The Sheep Detectives

Delightfully eccentric, surprisingly moving and packed with witty dialogue, this family-friendly mystery balances laughs with genuine emotion. Imagine Knives Out crossed with Babe and you get the idea. When a beloved shepherd, played by Hugh Jackman, dies under suspicious circumstances, his flock work to crack the case. Beneath the woolly charm lies a thoughtful tale about grief, courage and community, making it one of the year's most unexpected cinematic pleasures. It should be in the best picture race.



I Swear

Based on the extraordinary true story of Scottish Tourette syndrome campaigner John Davidson, I Swear follows one man's fight to be seen beyond his condition in a world that rarely understands it. Robert Aramayo delivers a star making performance - funny, heartbreaking and utterly authentic without ever slipping into caricature. He was a surprise winner of the Best Actor BAFTA for it and deserves to be in the Oscar conversation too for this emotional and beautifully observed film that earns every tear and every smile



Pressure

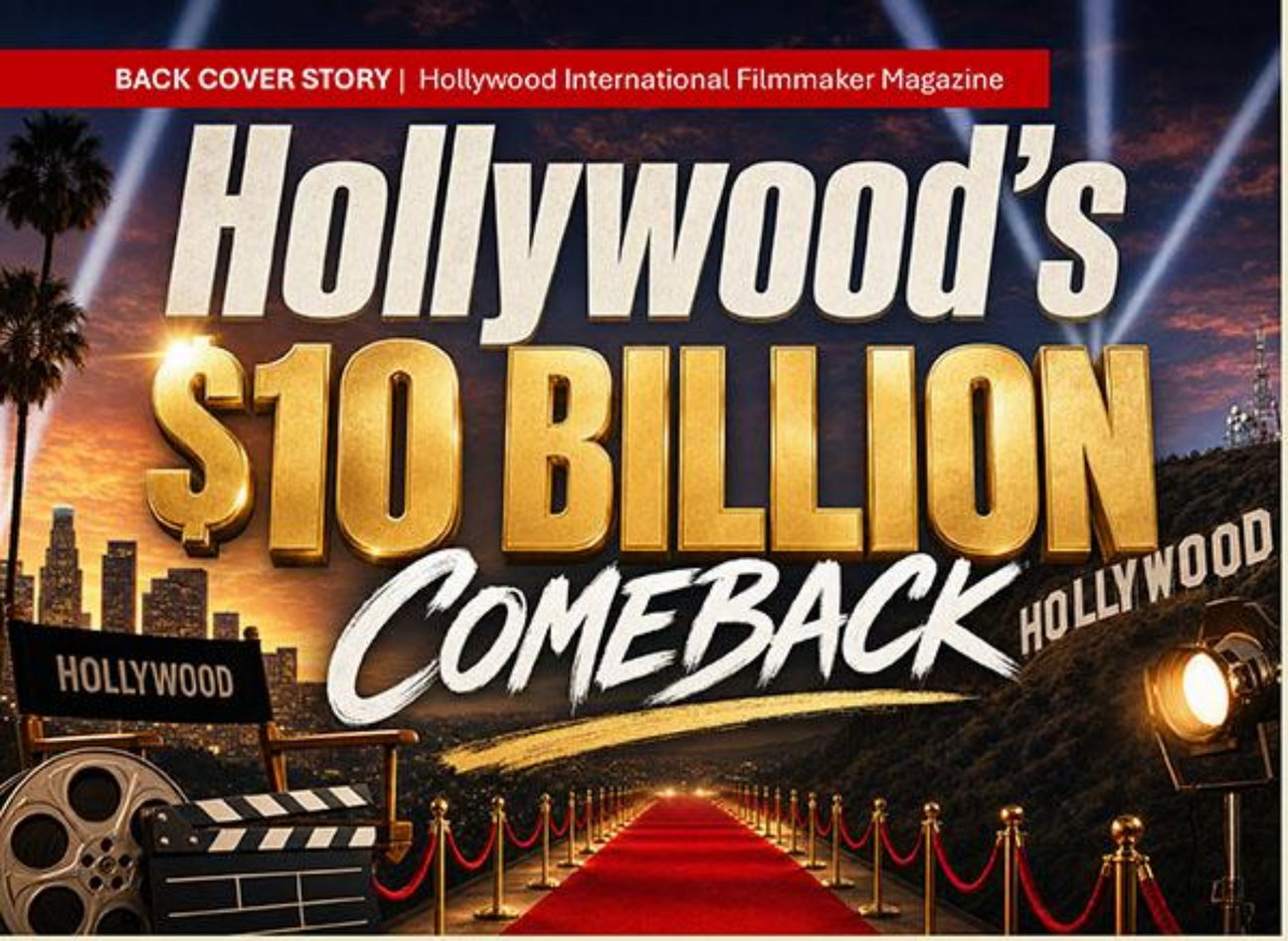
An edge-of-your-seat war film that gives a gripping account of the three days before D-Day and shows that the greatest battles are sometimes fought in meeting rooms. As weather forecasts threaten the Allied invasion, military leaders clash and face impossible decisions where every hour could change history. Pressure finds its thrills in tense conversations, moral dilemmas and superb performances, especially from Andrew Scott as the weatherman who urges military chiefs to postpone the operation when he predicts a huge storm is coming.

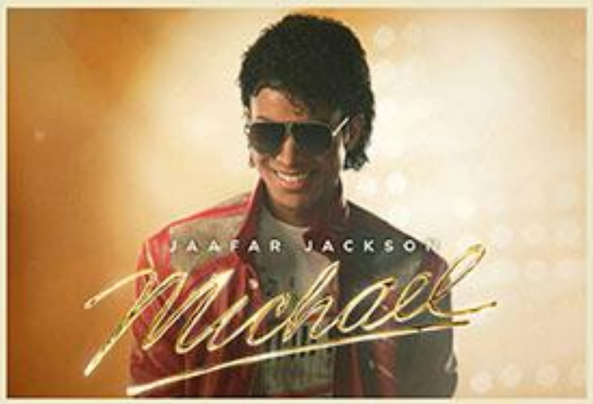


Obsession

What begins as an unsettling supernatural romance quickly spirals into one of the year's most disturbing horror films. A lonely young man gets exactly what he wishes for but discovers that love born from obsession carries a terrifying cost. Stylishly directed, deeply unnerving and emotionally raw, Obsession lingers long after the credits roll. Lead actress Inde Navarrette deserved an Oscar nomination for her emotional and unhinged performance.

Hollywood's $10 BILLION COMEBACK





Industry fears that moviegoing was finished have proved unfounded thanks to an astonishing box office bounce back in 2026.

American theatrical ticket sales are on track to surpass $10 billion for the first time since before the pandemic, a milestone that many executives had questioned only a year ago.

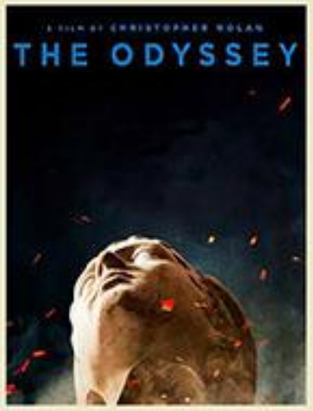
Powering the turnaround has been a consistent release calendar and stronger audience demand for theatrical experiences.

A major contributor has been science-fiction film Project Hail Mary, which has become one of the year's defining theatrical successes. The Ryan Gosling-led film surpassed $300 million globally, providing evidence that audiences will still turn out for original, non-franchise movies with broad appeal.

Talking of broad appeal, other unexpected hits included low budget horror movies Obsession and Backrooms and music biopic Michael, which showed that cinemas need not rely solely on sequels and superhero releases.

Then in the summer came major titles like Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey and Spider-Man: Brand New Day while still to come at the end of the year are Avengers: Doomsday and Dune which are expected to extend the box-office momentum through the remainder of 2026.







Exhibitors say one of the biggest lessons from 2026 is that consistency matters more than individual blockbusters. This year, audiences have had a steady pipeline of family films, horror titles, prestige dramas and original event movies, helping maintain attendance over a longer period.

Premium large-format screenings remain an important driver of revenue. Project Hail Mary and The Odyssey generated a significant share of their opening weekend takings from IMAX and other premium auditoriums, reflecting audiences' willingness to pay higher ticket prices for event films that offer experiences difficult to replicate at home.

The takeaway from all this is that exhibitors believe the industry's recovery is no longer dependent on a handful of blockbusters. Instead, they argue that a balanced release slate featuring franchises, original films and mid-budget successes has restored confidence in the theatrical model.

While challenges remain, executives increasingly view the 2026 numbers as the strongest indication yet that moviegoing has established a sustainable post-pandemic recovery rather than just experiencing a temporary rebound.



5 REASONS MOVIEGOING REBOUNDED IN 2026



1 **Hollywood restored a full release** schedule after the pandemic and 2023 strikes, giving audiences a steady stream of films to see.



2 **Studios shifted back to theatrical releases** after realizing streaming alone was less profitable than expected.



3 **Moviegoing became an event experience,** with audiences turning out for films that feel worth seeing on the big screen.



4 **Premium formats like IMAX and** luxury cinemas encouraged people to pay more for a theatrical experience they can't replicate at home.



5 **Original films are succeeding** alongside franchises, proving audiences will support new stores when they're well made and well marketed



☆ **The big screen experience is back — and audiences showed up.** **THANK YOU, MOVIEGOERS!**













The Biggest Domestic Opening Weekends of 2026

Spider-Man: Brand New Day ($360 million): The largest North American debut ever, beating previous record holder Avengers; Endgame

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Toy Story 5 ($160 million): Opened in June as the highest animated and overall domestic debut of the year-to-date.

The Super Mario Galaxy Movie ($131 million): Debuted in April with massive family and fan turnouts.

The Odyssey ($124.5 million): Released in July, marking Christopher Nolan's biggest live-action and R-rated opening success.

Michael ($97 million): Premiered in April as the largest opening ever for a biopic.

Project Hail Mary ($80.58 million): The sci-fi smash launched in March and was second only to Barbie as Ryan Gosling's biggest ever opening weekend.

Still to Come...

December releases Avengers: Doomsday and Dune: Part Three are also tracking for huge opening weekends.



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